



End Term (Even) Semester Examination May-June 2025

Roll no.....

Name of the Program and semester: B.A. (II) ENGLISH, VI Semester

Name of the Course: Modern European Drama

Course Code: ECC-601

Time: 3 hour

Maximum Marks: 100

Note:

- (i) All the questions are compulsory.
- (ii) Answer any two sub questions from a, b and c in each main question.
- (iii) Total marks for each question is 20 (twenty).
- (iv) Each sub-question carries 10 marks.

Q1. (2X10=20 Marks)

- a. In what ways does *Ghosts* criticize the moral standards and social conventions of 19th-century society? Consider the roles of religion, reputation, and gender expectations in your analysis. (CO1)
- b. Examine the character of Mrs. Alving in *Ghosts*. How does she reflect both the limitations and the quiet resistance of women in a patriarchal society? (CO1)
- c. Analyze how the play *Ghosts* presents inherited guilt—both moral and biological—and examine how the characters, especially Oswald and Mrs. Alving, are haunted by the past. (CO1)

Q2. (2X10=20 Marks)

- a. In *The Good Woman of Setzuan*, Brecht explores the tension between goodness and survival in a capitalist society. Analyze how the character of Shen Te/Shui Ta embodies this conflict, and discuss how Brecht uses this duality to critique social and economic structures. (CO2)
- b. Examine the role of the gods in the play *The Good Woman of Setzuan*. What do their actions (or inactions) suggest about divine justice in the world Brecht creates? (CO2)
- c. How do the secondary characters (such as Mrs. Shin, Yang Sun, and the carpenter) represent different aspects of society and human behavior in the play *The Good Woman of Setzuan*? (CO2)

Q3. (2X10=20 Marks)

- a. Analyze the religious and philosophical symbolism in *Waiting for Godot*. To what extent can Godot be interpreted as a representation of God, salvation, or existential hope? (CO3)
- b. Explore the emotional and psychological bond between Vladimir and Estragon in *Waiting for Godot*. Consider how their interactions oscillate between affection, irritation, and fear of abandonment, and what this reveals about human need for connection in a meaningless world. (CO3)
- c. Beckett employs repetition, circular dialogue, and minimal action in *Waiting for Godot*. How do these stylistic features enhance the play's meaning? (CO3)



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Q4.

(2X10=20 Marks)

a. How does Ionesco use absurdist elements in *Rhinoceros* to critique societal conformity and the loss of individuality? Discuss with reference to the transformation of the townspeople and Berenger's resistance. (CO4)

b. Examine *Rhinoceros* as an allegory for the rise of totalitarian ideologies (e.g., fascism or communism). How does Ionesco depict the seductive and contagious nature of extremist beliefs? (CO4)

c. Is Berenger's final declaration—"I will not capitulate!"—a hopeful act of resistance or a tragic cry of futility? Analyze the ending in the context of Ionesco's philosophical worldview. (CO4)

Q5.

(2X10=20 Marks)

a. Discuss how Pastor Manders in the play *Ghosts*, embodies societal hypocrisy and blind adherence to convention. (CO1)

b. In what ways do Pozzo and Lucky serve as foils to Vladimir and Estragon in the play *Waiting for Godot*, and what does their evolving relationship signify? (CO3)

c. In what ways does *Rhinoceros* reflect existential themes, such as alienation, meaninglessness, and authenticity? Discuss how the play's absurdity contributes to a deeper philosophical reflection. (CO4)